CANADA IMMIGRATION

Visa Categories, Subcategories & Visa Codes A–Z

Database reference: Category and subcategory codes and many short visa codes are suggested website identifiers. Canada does not use one universal numbered visa-subclass system like Australia.

Important: This PDF compiles the preceding chat result. It is a broad programme catalogue, not an official exhaustive IRCC register. Some entries are permits, programmes, streams, travel documents, citizenship pathways or internal database labels—not standalone visas. Verify current programme intake, eligibility and official names with IRCC before publishing.

Official sources: https://ircc.canada.ca/explore-programs/ | https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada.html

1. Main Canada Immigration Categories

Category code	Category name
VISIT	Visitor & Tourist Visas
BUSINESS_VISIT	Business Visitor Visas
TRANSIT	Transit Visas
WORK	Work & Employment Permits
OPEN_WORK	Open Work Permits
EMPLOYER_WORK	Employer-Specific Work Permits
AGRICULTURE	Agricultural Worker Programmes
SKILLED	Skilled Worker Immigration
EXPRESS_ENTRY	Express Entry Immigration
PROVINCIAL	Provincial Nominee Program
REGIONAL	Regional Immigration Programmes
QUEBEC	Quebec Immigration Programmes
STUDENT	Student & Education Permits
GRADUATE	Post-Graduation Work Permits
EXCHANGE	International Exchange Programmes
FAMILY	Family Sponsorship
PARTNER	Spouse & Partner Sponsorship
CHILD	Child & Adoption Immigration
PARENT	Parents & Grandparents Sponsorship
BUSINESS	Business Immigration
INVESTOR	Investor Immigration
ENTREPRENEUR	Entrepreneur Immigration
STARTUP	Start-up Visa
SELF_EMPLOYED	Self-Employed Immigration
CAREGIVER	Caregiver Immigration
HUMANITARIAN	Humanitarian Immigration
REFUGEE	Refugee & Asylum Protection
PROTECTED_PERSON	Protected Persons
SPECIAL	Special Immigration Programmes
TEMPORARY_RESIDENT	Temporary Resident Permits
PERMANENT_RESIDENT	Permanent Residency
RESIDENT_RETURN	Permanent Resident Travel Documents
CITIZENSHIP	Canadian Citizenship
LEGACY	Closed & Repealed Immigration Programmes

2. Visitor, Tourist & Business Visas — VISIT

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
TOURIST	Tourist Visitor	TRV	Temporary Resident Visa
SINGLE_ENTRY	Single Entry Visitor	TRV-SE	Single Entry Temporary Resident Visa
MULTIPLE_ENTRY	Multiple Entry Visitor	TRV-ME	Multiple Entry Temporary Resident Visa
SUPER_VISA	Parents & Grandparents	SV	Super Visa
BUSINESS_VISITOR	Business Visitor	BV	Business Visitor
VISITOR_RECORD	Visitor Status Extension	VR	Visitor Record
TEMPORARY_RESIDENT	Temporary Resident	TRP	Temporary Resident Permit
TOURISM_ETA	Electronic Travel Authorization	ETA	Electronic Travel Authorization

3. Transit Visas — TRANSIT

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
AIRPORT_TRANSIT	Airport Transit	TV	Transit Visa
AIR_TRANSIT	Air Transit Without Visa	TWOV	Transit Without Visa Programme
CHINA_TRANSIT	China Transit Programme	CTP	China Transit Programme

4. Work & Employment Permits — WORK

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
EMPLOYER_SPECIFIC	Employer-Specific Work Permit	WP-EMP	Employer-Specific Work Permit
OPEN_WORK	Open Work Permit	WP-OPEN	Open Work Permit
LMIA_BASED	LMIA-Based Work Permit	WP-LMIA	LMIA-Based Work Permit
LMIA_EXEMPT	LMIA-Exempt Work Permit	WP-EXEMPT	LMIA-Exempt Work Permit
GLOBAL_SKILLS	Global Skills Strategy	GSS	Global Skills Strategy Work Permit
INTRA_COMPANY	Intra-Company Transfer	ICT	Intra-Company Transferee Work Permit
SIGNIFICANT_BENEFIT	Significant Benefit	WP-SB	Significant Benefit Work Permit
INTERNATIONAL_AGREEMENT	International Agreement	WP-IA	International Agreement Work Permit
SPOUSAL_WORK	Spousal Open Work Permit	SOWP	Spousal Open Work Permit
BRIDGING_WORK	Bridging Open Work Permit	BOWP	Bridging Open Work Permit
POST_GRADUATE	Post-Graduation Work	PGWP	Post-Graduation Work Permit
CHARITABLE_RELIGIOUS	Charitable or Religious Work	WP-CR	Charitable or Religious Work Permit

5. Agricultural & Seasonal Worker Programmes — AGRICULTURE

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
SAWP	Seasonal Agricultural Worker	SAWP	Seasonal Agricultural Worker Programme
AGRICULTURAL_STREAM	Agricultural Stream	TFW-AG	Temporary Foreign Worker – Agricultural Stream
LOW_WAGE	Low-Wage Labour Stream	TFW-LW	Temporary Foreign Worker – Low-Wage Stream
HIGH_WAGE	High-Wage Labour Stream	TFW-HW	Temporary Foreign Worker – High-Wage Stream
PRIMARY_AGRICULTURE	Primary Agriculture	PA	Primary Agriculture Work Permit

6. Skilled Worker & Express Entry — EXPRESS_ENTRY

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
CANADIAN_EXPERIENCE	Canadian Experience Class	CEC	Canadian Experience Class
FEDERAL_SKILLED_WORKER	Federal Skilled Worker	FSW	Federal Skilled Worker Program
FEDERAL_SKILLED_TRADES	Federal Skilled Trades	FST	Federal Skilled Trades Program
EXPRESS_ENTRY_PNP	Express Entry Provincial Nominee	EE-PNP	Provincial Nominee – Express Entry
CATEGORY_BASED	Category-Based Selection	EE-CBS	Express Entry Category-Based Selection
FRENCH_LANGUAGE	French Language Proficiency	EE-FR	French-Language Proficiency Category
HEALTHCARE	Healthcare Occupations	EE-HC	Healthcare and Social Services Category
STEM	Science & Technology	EE-STEM	STEM Occupations Category
TRADES	Skilled Trades Occupations	EE-TRADES	Trades Occupations Category

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
EDUCATION	Education Occupations	EE-EDU	Education Occupations Category
AGRICULTURE_FOOD	Agriculture & Agri-Food	EE-AGRI	Agriculture and Agri-Food Category

7. Provincial Nominee Program — PROVINCIAL

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
ALBERTA_PNP	Alberta Nominee	AAIP	Alberta Advantage Immigration Program
BC_PNP	British Columbia Nominee	BCPNP	BC Provincial Nominee Program
MANITOBA_PNP	Manitoba Nominee	MPNP	Manitoba Provincial Nominee Program
NEW_BRUNSWICK_PNP	New Brunswick Nominee	NBPNP	New Brunswick Provincial Nominee Program
NEWFOUNDLAND_PNP	Newfoundland & Labrador Nominee	NLPNP	Newfoundland and Labrador Provincial Nominee Program
NOVA_SCOTIA_PNP	Nova Scotia Nominee	NSNP	Nova Scotia Nominee Program
ONTARIO_PNP	Ontario Nominee	OINP	Ontario Immigrant Nominee Program
PEI_PNP	Prince Edward Island Nominee	PEI-PNP	PEI Provincial Nominee Program
SASKATCHEWAN_PNP	Saskatchewan Nominee	SINP	Saskatchewan Immigrant Nominee Program
NORTHWEST_TERRITORIES_PNP	Northwest Territories Nominee	NTNP	Northwest Territories Nominee Program
YUKON_PNP	Yukon Nominee	YNP	Yukon Nominee Program

8. Regional Immigration Programmes — REGIONAL

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
ATLANTIC	Atlantic Immigration	AIP	Atlantic Immigration Program
RURAL_COMMUNITY	Rural Community Immigration	RCIP	Rural Community Immigration Pilot
FRANCOPHONE_COMMUNITY	Francophone Community Immigration	FCIP	Francophone Community Immigration Pilot
NORTHERN_COMMUNITY	Rural and Northern Immigration	RNIP	Rural and Northern Immigration Pilot – Legacy
ECONOMIC_MOBILITY	Economic Mobility Pathways	EMPP	Economic Mobility Pathways Pilot
ATLANTIC_GRADUATE	Atlantic International Graduate	AIP-IG	Atlantic International Graduate Stream – Historical stream name

9. Quebec Immigration Programmes — QUEBEC

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
QUEBEC_SKILLED	Quebec Skilled Worker	PSTQ	Programme de sélection des travailleurs qualifiés
QUEBEC_EXPERIENCE	Quebec Experience	PEQ	Quebec Experience Program
QUEBEC_INVESTOR	Quebec Investor	QI	Quebec Immigrant Investor Program
QUEBEC_ENTREPRENEUR	Quebec Entrepreneur	QE	Quebec Entrepreneur Program
QUEBEC_SELF_EMPLOYED	Quebec Self-Employed	QSE	Quebec Self-Employed Worker Program
QUEBEC_FAMILY	Quebec Family Sponsorship	QFS	Quebec Family Reunification
QUEBEC_SELECTION	Quebec Selection	CSQ	Quebec Selection Certificate

10. Student & Education Permits — STUDENT

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
INTERNATIONAL_STUDENT	International Student	SP	Study Permit
MINOR_STUDENT	Minor Student	SP-MINOR	Study Permit for Minor
STUDENT_EXTENSION	Study Permit Extension	SP-EXT	Study Permit Extension
STUDENT_EXCHANGE	Exchange Student	SP-EX	Exchange Student Study Permit
STUDENT_COOP	Co-op Student	COOP-WP	Co-op Work Permit
STUDENT_VISITOR	Short-Term Study Visitor	STSV	Short-Term Study Without Study Permit
STUDENT_DEPENDENT	Student Dependent	SD	Dependent Family Member Status

11. Post-Graduation & Graduate Work Permits — GRADUATE

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
POST_GRADUATION	Post-Graduation Work	PGWP	Post-Graduation Work Permit
GRADUATE_EXTENSION	Work Permit Extension	PGWP-EXT	Post-Graduation Work Permit Extension
GRADUATE_BRIDGING	Bridging Graduate Worker	BOWP	Bridging Open Work Permit
STUDENT_TO_WORK	Student to Worker	S2W	Student-to-Worker Pathway – General database label

12. International Exchange & Youth Programmes — EXCHANGE

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
WORKING_HOLIDAY	Working Holiday	IEC-WH	International Experience Canada – Working Holiday
YOUNG_PROFESSIONALS	Young Professionals	IEC-YP	International Experience Canada – Young Professionals
INTERNATIONAL_COOP	International Co-op Internship	IEC-COOP	International Experience Canada – International Co-op
RECOGNIZED_ORGANIZATION	Recognized Organization	IEC-RO	International Experience Canada – Recognized Organization
RECIPROCAL_EXCHANGE	Reciprocal Youth Exchange	IEC-RE	International Experience Canada – Reciprocal Exchange

13. Family Sponsorship & Partner Immigration — FAMILY

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
SPOUSE	Spouse Sponsorship	FAM-SPOUSE	Spouse Sponsorship – Permanent Residence
COMMON_LAW	Common-Law Partner	FAM-CLP	Common-Law Partner Sponsorship
CONJUGAL	Conjugal Partner	FAM-CONJUGAL	Conjugal Partner Sponsorship
INLAND_SPOUSE	Inland Spouse	FAM-INLAND	In-Canada Spouse or Common-Law Partner Class
OUTLAND_SPOUSE	Overseas Spouse	FAM-OUTLAND	Family Class Sponsorship
DEPENDENT_CHILD	Dependent Child	FAM-CHILD	Dependent Child Sponsorship
ADOPTED_CHILD	Adopted Child	FAM-ADOPT	Adopted Child Sponsorship
OTHER_RELATIVE	Other Relative	FAM-REL	Other Relative Sponsorship – Eligible Cases

14. Parents & Grandparents Sponsorship — PARENT

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
PARENT_SPONSORSHIP	Parent Sponsorship	PGP	Parents and Grandparents Program
GRANDPARENT_SPONSORSHIP	Grandparent Sponsorship	PGP-GP	Grandparent Sponsorship
PARENT_SUPER_VISA	Parent Super Visa	SV-P	Parent and Grandparent Super Visa
PARENT_VISITOR	Parent Visitor	TRV-P	Parent Visitor Visa
PARENT_VISITOR_RECORD	Parent Visitor Extension	VR-P	Parent Visitor Record

15. Child & Adoption Immigration — CHILD

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
DEPENDENT_CHILD	Dependent Child	CHILD-PR	Dependent Child Permanent Residence
INTERNATIONAL_ADOPTION	International Adoption	ADOPT-PR	Adopted Child Permanent Residence
ORPHANED_RELATIVE	Orphaned Relative	ORPHAN-PR	Orphaned Relative Sponsorship
CHILD_PROTECTION	Child Protection	CHILD-HC	Child Humanitarian Immigration
CHILD_CITIZENSHIP	Citizenship by Descent	CIT-DESC	Citizenship by Descent – Not a Visa

16. Caregiver Immigration — CAREGIVER

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
HOME_CHILDCARE	Home Child Care	HCCP	Home Child Care Provider Pilot – Legacy
HOME_SUPPORT	Home Support Worker	HSWP	Home Support Worker Pilot – Legacy
CHILDCARE_PILOT	Home Care Worker – Child Care	HCW-CC	Home Care Worker Immigration Pilot – Child Care
HOMECARE_PILOT	Home Care Worker – Home Support	HCW-HS	Home Care Worker Immigration Pilot – Home Support
LIVE_IN_CAREGIVER	Live-in Caregiver	LCP	Live-in Caregiver Program – Legacy

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
CAREGIVER_PR	Caregiver Permanent Residence	CG-PR	Caregiver Permanent Residence Pathway

17. Business, Investor & Entrepreneur Immigration — BUSINESS

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
STARTUP_VISA	Start-up Business	SUV	Start-up Visa Program
SELF_EMPLOYED	Self-Employed	SEP	Self-Employed Persons Program
FEDERAL_INVESTOR	Federal Investor	FIP	Federal Immigrant Investor Program – Closed
FEDERAL_ENTREPRENEUR	Federal Entrepreneur	FEP	Federal Entrepreneur Program – Closed
QUEBEC_INVESTOR	Quebec Investor	QI	Quebec Immigrant Investor Program
QUEBEC_ENTREPRENEUR	Quebec Entrepreneur	QE	Quebec Entrepreneur Program
PROVINCIAL_ENTREPRENEUR	Provincial Entrepreneur	PEP	Provincial Entrepreneur Immigration Streams
BUSINESS_VISITOR	Business Visitor	BV	Business Visitor Status
OWNER_OPERATOR	Owner-Operator	OO	Owner-Operator Work Permit Strategy – Not a standalone visa

18. Humanitarian & Compassionate Immigration — HUMANITARIAN

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
H_AND_C	Humanitarian & Compassionate	HC-PR	Humanitarian and Compassionate Permanent Residence
PUBLIC_POLICY	Public Policy	PP-PR	Public Policy Permanent Residence Pathway
FAMILY_HUMANITARIAN	Family Humanitarian	FH-PR	Family-Based Humanitarian Pathway
AFGHAN_HUMANITARIAN	Afghan Humanitarian	AFG-PR	Afghan Special Immigration Pathways
UKRAINIAN_HUMANITARIAN	Ukraine Special Measures	UKR-PR	Ukraine-Related Permanent Residence Pathways
HONG_KONG	Hong Kong Pathway	HK-PR	Hong Kong Permanent Residence Pathways
VULNERABLE_WORKER	Vulnerable Worker	VW-OP	Open Work Permit for Vulnerable Workers

19. Refugee, Asylum & Protection Immigration — REFUGEE

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
CONVENTION_REFUGEE	Convention Refugee	CR-PR	Convention Refugee Permanent Residence
COUNTRY_OF_ASYLUM	Country of Asylum	COA-PR	Country of Asylum Class
GOVERNMENT_ASSISTED	Government Assisted Refugee	GAR	Government-Assisted Refugee Programme
PRIVATELY_SPONSORED	Privately Sponsored Refugee	PSR	Private Sponsorship of Refugees
BLENDED_VISA_OFFICE	Blended Visa Office-Referred	BVOR	Blended Visa Office-Referred Refugee Programme
GROUP_OF_FIVE	Group of Five Sponsorship	G5	Group of Five Refugee Sponsorship
SPONSORSHIP_AGREEMENT	Sponsorship Agreement Holder	SAH	Sponsorship Agreement Holder Programme
ASYLUM_CLAIM	Asylum Claim	ASYLUM	Refugee Protection Claim
PROTECTED_PERSON	Protected Person	PP-PR	Protected Person Permanent Residence
PRE_REMOVAL_RISK	Pre-Removal Risk Assessment	PRRA	Pre-Removal Risk Assessment
REFUGEE_TRAVEL	Refugee Travel Document	RTD	Refugee Travel Document
CERTIFICATE_IDENTITY	Certificate of Identity	COI	Canadian Certificate of Identity

20. Temporary Resident Permits & Special Entry — TEMPORARY_RESIDENT

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
TEMPORARY_RESIDENT_PERMIT	Temporary Resident Permit	TRP	Temporary Resident Permit
CRIMINAL_REHABILITATION	Criminal Rehabilitation	CR	Criminal Rehabilitation – Not a Visa
DEEMED_REHABILITATION	Deemed Rehabilitation	DR	Deemed Rehabilitation – Not a Visa
AUTHORIZATION_RETURN	Authorization to Return to Canada	ARC	Authorization to Return to Canada
CRIMINAL_INADMISSIBILITY	Criminal Inadmissibility Relief	CIR	Inadmissibility Relief – Not a Visa
EMERGENCY_TRAVEL	Emergency Travel	ETD	Emergency Travel Document – Not a Visa
TEMPORARY_POLICY	Temporary Public Policy	TPP	Temporary Public Policy Immigration Measure

21. Permanent Residency & Resident Documents — PERMANENT_RESIDENT

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
PERMANENT_RESIDENCE	Permanent Residence	PR	Canadian Permanent Residence
PR_CONFIRMATION	Confirmation of PR	COPR	Confirmation of Permanent Residence
PR_CARD	Permanent Resident Card	PRC	Permanent Resident Card
PR_TRAVEL_DOCUMENT	Permanent Resident Travel Document	PRTD	Permanent Resident Travel Document
PR_RENEWAL	PR Card Renewal	PR-RENEW	Permanent Resident Card Renewal
PR_REPLACEMENT	PR Card Replacement	PR-REPLACE	Replacement Permanent Resident Card
PR_STATUS	Permanent Resident Status	PR-STATUS	Permanent Resident Status Verification

22. Returning Resident & Residency Obligations — RESIDENT_RETURN

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
RETURNING_PR	Returning Permanent Resident	PRTD	Permanent Resident Travel Document
RESIDENCY_OBLIGATION	Residency Obligation	RO	Permanent Resident Residency Obligation
PR_STATUS_DETERMINATION	PR Status Determination	PRSD	Permanent Resident Status Determination
VOLUNTARY_RENUNCIATION	Voluntary Renunciation	PR-REN	Renunciation of Permanent Resident Status

23. Canadian Citizenship & Naturalization — CITIZENSHIP

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
NATURALIZATION	Citizenship by Naturalization	CIT-NAT	Canadian Citizenship by Grant
DESCENT	Citizenship by Descent	CIT-DES	Canadian Citizenship by Descent
MINOR_CITIZENSHIP	Minor Citizenship	CIT-MIN	Citizenship for Minors
ADOPTED_CITIZENSHIP	Adopted Child Citizenship	CIT-ADOPT	Citizenship for Adopted Persons
RESUMPTION	Resumption of Citizenship	CIT-RES	Resumption of Canadian Citizenship
CITIZENSHIP_CERTIFICATE	Citizenship Certificate	CIT-CERT	Proof of Canadian Citizenship
CITIZENSHIP_RENUNCIATION	Renunciation	CIT-REN	Renunciation of Canadian Citizenship

24. Closed, Suspended & Legacy Programmes — LEGACY

Subcategory code	Programme code	Programme name
FEDERAL_INVESTOR	FIP	Federal Immigrant Investor Program
FEDERAL_ENTREPRENEUR	FEP	Federal Entrepreneur Program
QUEBEC_INVESTOR_LEGACY	QI-LEGACY	Previous Quebec Investor Programme
QUEBEC_ENTREPRENEUR_LEGACY	QE-LEGACY	Previous Quebec Entrepreneur Programme
LIVE_IN_CAREGIVER	LCP	Live-in Caregiver Program
HOME_CHILDCARE_LEGACY	HCCP	Home Child Care Provider Pilot
HOME_SUPPORT_LEGACY	HSWP	Home Support Worker Pilot
RNIP	RNIP	Rural and Northern Immigration Pilot
ATLANTIC_PILOT	AIPP	Atlantic Immigration Pilot – Legacy
AGRI_FOOD	AFP	Agri-Food Pilot
STARTUP_LEGACY	SUV-LEGACY	Previous Start-up Visa intake arrangements
SELF_EMPLOYED_LEGACY	SEP-LEGACY	Self-Employed Persons Program – Intake restrictions
TR_TO_PR	TR2PR	Temporary Resident to Permanent Resident Pathway
CAREGIVER_LEGACY	CG-LEGACY	Previous Caregiver Immigration Pathways
FSW_LEGACY	FSW-LEGACY	Previous Federal Skilled Worker selection arrangements

25. Additional Immigration & Special Programmes — SPECIAL

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
MEDICAL_INADMISSIBILITY	Medical Inadmissibility	MED-EX	Medical Inadmissibility Exemption

Subcategory code	Subcategory name	Visa code	Visa name
INTERNATIONAL_MOBILITY	International Mobility	IMP	International Mobility Program
FRANCOPHONE_MOBILITY	Francophone Mobility	FM-WP	Francophone Mobility Work Permit
RELIGIOUS_WORKER	Religious Worker	RW-WP	Religious Worker Work Permit
ACADEMIC_WORKER	Academic Worker	AW-WP	Academic Work Permit
POST_DOCTORAL	Postdoctoral Researcher	PD-WP	Postdoctoral Work Permit
CHARITY_WORKER	Charity Worker	CW-WP	Charitable Work Permit
RECIPROCAL_EMPLOYMENT	Reciprocal Employment	RE-WP	Reciprocal Employment Work Permit
SIGNIFICANT_BENEFIT	Significant Benefit	SB-WP	Significant Benefit Work Permit
INTRA_COMPANY	Intra-Company Transfer	ICT-WP	Intra-Company Transfer Work Permit